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Virginia Board of Education, Work Session, Wednesday, June 14, 2023

Date	Wednesday, June 14, 2023
Place	Virginia Board of Education (Virginia Department of Education), Richmond, Virginia
Length	9h 27m (video)

- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=F9JzuqQDXvE
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-23. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:09:20] good morning good morning uh welcome to the executive session of the Virginia board event uh I demand do you have a motion to make I do Mr President oh before we before we start thanks geez I've already forgot uh Miss Love do you have somebody you'd like to introduce to the board I'd like to introduce I'd like to introduce and in some cases reintroduce Nancy Walsh to the board uh Nancy retired from the department of education two three years ago two years ago uh having worked in the professional practice area and when i heard that she was thinking about maybe coming back and

[00:09:57] doing some part-time work i snapped her up and she's now appointed by the attorney general uh so as a member of our office working part-time and her focus is on the licensure matters that regularly come before the board um you know last year i had three lawyers who were working with me representing some aspect of the department of education and they all three left they assured me it had nothing to do with me but uh we're building back and you've met adam um keen who's doing sped and abby gump who's kind of a generalist and doing early childhood stuff and now we've got nancy we've got susan williams back so we're rebuilding the team and nancy it's been i know the board will be

[00:10:35] extremely grateful to have nancy's expertise um back working on behalf of the board so she's thanks and welcome i mean certainly those of us who worked with you before are incredibly delighted to

have you back and those who are moving forward with you will become incredibly delighted as that occurs so yeah very happy to have you back all right uh they have told me that i'm not allowed to leave until we clean up my entire backlog of cases so today is going to be a busy day uh this morning is going to be a busy morning and we are going to you know move through it

[00:11:10] as expeditiously as possible dr mandy have a motion i do mr president i move that the virginia board of education convened in a closed meeting for the following purposes the discussion and consideration of records relating to denial suspension or revocation of teacher licenses pursuant to virginia code 2.2-3711 a41 and to consult with counsel and receive legal advice regarding the same pursuant to virginia code 2.237 11 a7 of the code of virginia and that legal council to the virginia board of education and staff whose presence will aid in the board's

[00:11:49] consideration of this matter participate in the closed meeting we have motions there a second all those in favor signify by saying aye all right we're going to go into executive session

[00:12:01] we'll certify uh dr man we convene today in a closed meeting meeting pursuant to a recorded

[06:52:18] vote on the motion above in accordance with the freedom of information act section 2.2-3712 of the code of virginia requires that the board certify that to the best of each member's knowledge one only public business matters lawfully exempt from open meeting requirements under this chapter and two only such public business matters as were defined in the motion by which the closed meeting was convened were heard discussed or considered any member who believes there was a departure from these requirements shall so state prior to the vote indicating the substance of that departure in his or her judgment has taken place the statement of the departure will be recorded in

[06:52:54] the minutes okay uh let's certify by roll call miss creasy miss holton dr sievert dr mann hi mr hanson uh mr sturdivant hi uh mr rotherham hi chair votes i chair will entertain a motion to revoke the license of clifton carl williams jr is there a motion kevin says we're live okay yeah i thought we had thought we had but we are live and we are back in public session okay chair will entertain a motion to revoke the license of cooking carl williams jr thank you miss creasy

[06:53:30] is there a second second okay all those excuse me by roll call miss creasy miss holton dr siebert dr mann mr hanson mr sturdifant mr rotherham hi and chair votes uh chair will entertain a motion to uh deny a license to darius montreal mumford is there a motion thank you mr uh anson is there a second second uh thank you dr man again by roll call miss creasy uh miss holton dr siebert dr man mr hanson just third of an eye and mr rotherham and chair votes aye uh chair will

[06:54:09] entertain a motion to revoke the license of brendan mitchell henry is there a motion thank - Thank you, Dr. Siebert, seconded by Mr. Hansen. Again, roll call, Ms. Creasy. Ms. Houlton. - Aye. - Dr. Siebert. - Aye. - Dr. Mann. - Aye.

[06:54:24] - Mr. Sturdifant. - Aye. - Mr. Rotherham. - Aye. - And chair votes aye. Chair will entertain a motion to issue a license renewal in case number four. - So moved. - Thank you, Dr. Mann, is there a second? - Second. - Thank you, Mr. Sturdifant. Ms. Creasy.

[06:54:40] - Aye. - Ms. Houlton. - Dr. Siebert. - Aye. - Mr. Hansen. - Aye. - Aye. - Mr. Rotherham. - Aye. - And chair votes aye. Chair will entertain a motion to issue a license in case number five.

[06:54:55] - Moved. - Thank you, Dr. Mann. Thank you, Dr. Siebert. Ms. Creasy. Ms. Holton. Dr. Siebert. - Aye. - Dr. Mann. - Aye. - Mr. Sturdifant. - Aye. - Mr. Rotherham. - Aye. - And chair votes aye. Chair will entertain a motion to issue a license in case number six.

[06:55:15] Thank you, Dr. Siebert, is there a second? - Second. - Thank you, Mr. Hanson. Ms. Creasy, Ms. Halton, Dr. Siebert, Dr. Mann, Mr. Hanson, Mr. Sturdifant, Mr. Rotherham and chair votes. Okay, board will entertain a motion to suspend the license of Travis Neil Kuhn for one year with reinstatement contingent upon submission of the following documentation to the superintendent of public instruction, evidence of completion of a course in anger management or slash deescalation strategies and documentation from a treating mental health professional regarding

[06:55:54] readiness to return to the classroom uh is there a motion thank you mr sturdifant is there a second thank you mr hanson miss creasy uh miss holton hi dr siebert hi dr man hi mr hanson hi um mr sturdifant by mr rotherham hi and chair votes i chair will entertain a motion to revoke the license of jacob michael mayfie so move thank you mr sturdifant is there a second second uh thank

[06:56:27] Thank you. Mr. Rotherham. Ms. Creasy? Ms. Holton? Aye. Dr. Siebert? Aye. Dr. Mann? Aye. Mr. Hanson? Stay. Mr. Sturdifant? Aye. Mr. Rotherham? Aye. Chair votes aye. Chair will entertain a motion to revoke the license of David Bryson Noyes. So moved. Thank you. Mr. Sturdifant, is there a second? Second. Thank you, Dr. Mann. Ms. Creasy? Aye. Ms. Holton? Aye. Dr. Siebert? Aye. Dr. Mann? Aye. Mr. Hanson?

[06:56:59] Mr. Sturdefin? Aye. Mr. Rotherham? Aye. And chair votes aye. Chair will entertain a motion to issue a license in case number 10. So moved. Thank you, Dr. Mann. Second by Ms. Creasy. Ms. Creasy? Aye. Ms. Holton? Aye. Dr. Siebert? Aye. Dr. Mann? Aye. Mr. Hanson? Aye. Mr. Sturdefin? Aye. Mr. Rotherham? Aye.

[06:57:23] Chair votes aye. Chair will entertain a motion to continue case 11 to July with a request to staff to get some further information that uh you will be told what it is is there a motion uh thank you mr sturdifant uh is there a second second thank you mr rotherham miss creasy uh miss holton hi oops dr sievert hi dr man hi mr hanson abstain uh mr sturdifant hi mr rotherham hi and chair votes excuse me chair votes i was going to say just for the record

[06:58:03] my three abstentions were not because of the substance but because of my absence that's right same with miss creasy she was absent for a few of the hearings uh thank you mr hanson all right uh chair will entertain a motion to deny a license to giovanni garcia is there a motion motion second miss creasy uh ms holton dr siebert hi dr man hey mr hanson hi mr sturdifant aye mr rotherham aye and chair votes aye uh chair will entertain a motion to revoke the license of

[06:58:40] charles oddie tucker is your motion thank you mr hanson second by uh dr man miss creasy miss holton dr sievert dr mann mr hanson mr sturdifant mr rotherham and chair votes aye and chair will entertain a motion to revoke the license of dalton matthew bates

[06:59:05] Thank you. Is there a second? Second. Thank you. Ms. Creasy? Ms. Halton? Aye. Dr. Siebert? Aye. Dr. Mann? Aye. Mr. Hanson? Aye. Mr. Sturdifant? Aye. Mr. Rotherham? Aye. And chair votes aye. That concludes the business of the executive session of the board. I am going to take, and the rest of you may or may not, and we will be back for the work session. We appreciate all of your patience. It's been a long day for all of us, but thank you.

[07:04:34] Patience. I think you know what we had going on this morning. Sometimes it goes long,

[07:09:39] sometimes it doesn't, but we do appreciate you all bearing with us. This is the work session for the hardest working unpaid board in the Commonwealth, the Virginia Board of Education. And the first item up is item A, applications from divisions partnering with iTeach to provide an alternative route to licensure and endorsements. And I say, Mr. Rozelle, We, in all seriousness, I know how difficult it is to just sit around cooling your heels while other people are doing other things.

[07:10:11] And I'm sorry if it seemed like a waste of time today and if we could have changed it, we would have. So we mean no discourtesy. Do I present here or do you want me to sit down? It's up to you. Whatever you're comfortable with, we're comfortable with. We thought the form of this would be some presentation and then board questions, as I understand it.

[07:10:30] And I think that's what you were prepped for. That's my understanding. Great. Yes, sir. Thank you. And again, thanks for coming back to be with us. I'll present, and then we can come up for questions. I'm going to set a clock for myself. Well, good afternoon, Superintendent Coons, President Gecker, and members of the board.

[07:10:57] I consider it a privilege to be able to present to you this afternoon, and there was no issue waiting at all. I understand pressing issues certainly take priority. As a reminder, I was able to speak to you in April. My name is Andrew Rozelle, and I get to serve as the president of iTeach.

[07:11:12] with me today who will help answer any questions this board might have is dr diane hubert she's the founder of i teach dr mo gaffney a regional director with i teach dr amy anderson who is our director of curriculum and instruction and additionally travis holder licensure coordinator with fairfax county public schools is present to answer any questions you might have about the division's application on september 1st 2022 governor youngkin signed executive order number three it reads in part quote the secretary of education shall collaborate with the superintendent

[07:11:49] of public instruction the secretary of finance the secretary of labor and the commissioner of the department of labor and industry to reduce red tape associated with teacher licensure while ensuring high standards in order to recruit more out-of-state teachers retired teachers career switchers military veterans and other professionals with much to offer students now it would be very convenient for me to claim this was the reason for i teach to partner with divisions across the commonwealth but that would not be accurate the truth is we had our first conversation with the

[07:12:23] division fairfax county public schools eight months prior to that executive order we had that conversation on december 10th 2021 following that initial discussion with mr holder several other divisions reached out to our office to discuss potential partnerships emerging from these discussions was our first signed mou our first signed mou is with chesapeake city public schools on january 14 2022 and briefly speaking on mous i'm aware of some questions regarding sole source language in our partnership agreements for each mou we have executed we have had

[07:13:00] conversations with each component in the agreement including this topic the applications were also vetted by divisions legal review process. The language in some MOUs does state that divisions would not partner with any non-IHE alternative certification program for a period of 24 months.

[07:13:19] Every division, however, can continue to partner with colleges and universities. Also, each division had the opportunity to remove this language altogether, which some elected to do so. It was not a deal breaker for a partnership to happen.

[07:13:35] From our initial partnership with Chesapeake City Public Schools, we began helping their team draft their application to the DOE. This joint authorship process took roughly six months as we wanted to ensure a quality application was submitted to the department. Our first application was submitted to the department on June 30, 2022. The effort with Chesapeake laid the groundwork for other potential partnerships. Since submitting the application, we have had the opportunity to meet with over 50 divisions, and as you know, 22 divisions have submitted an application thus far, with over a

[07:14:10] dozen other divisions partnering with us and working on their application. Despite ongoing conversations and emails with the team at the DOE, we did not receive formative feedback on the division's applications until earlier this year. Unfortunately, given the timeline of feedback and the needed turnaround deadlines, some of the requested items at the April meeting were actually in the original application, but not nearly as complete as they are now. We were happy to spend needed time to provide the board with a comprehensive walkthrough of our pre-k six course sequence once we understood the expectations and as for the requested documents i'd like to take a couple

[07:14:46] minutes to provide an overview of the documents we submitted there are four documents that i hope each of you have received and been able to review the first document was the matrix showing the approval requirements in two other states tennessee and nevada this document highlights the requirements of virginia as compared to two other states in which i teach is approved i teach is currently approved in 11 states so this chart serves to show a couple states that we have approved where our coursework is approved differently in tennessee our pedagogical course

[07:15:22] work satisfies the 300 contact hours required because the state's use of the praxis the doe uses the praxis content exam for demonstration of content knowledge tennessee does not require any literacy courses but we have our courses available to any teacher candidate wishing to enroll nevada is similar to tennessee with one significant difference the requirement of content methodology courses nevada does require constant methodology courses and similar to the conditions added to the divisions applications here these courses are able to be completed at a regionally accredited college or university the key difference is that nevada provides the option for teacher

[07:15:59] candidates to complete these methodology courses through iTeach, not just at a college or university. And this is our request to the board: allow our methods course to satisfy the methodology requirements. These courses can be completed through the iTeach program at no additional cost to the candidate. It's also worth noting that our coursework is continually updated for relevance, content, and alignment to state standards. As this board determines the needed content for teacher preparation our team will ensure course alignment additionally with regard to constant knowledge preparation we partner with the highest quality test preparation provider to ensure teachers can

[07:16:38] not just pass the exam but they're confident in their constant area once in the classroom this test prep is at no additional charge to our candidate either additionally we are accredited by quality matters and we are being reviewed by the deac under the approved quality curriculum part of their their program the second document was several pieces of evidence showing our teachers effectiveness we're able to provide you from three different sources our teacher effectiveness data source number one was the louisiana board of regents this data leverages the compass tool to

[07:17:12] ascertain teachers impact on student learning the second source was a campus administrator survey this survey is given internally for us to our campus administrators for their feedback on first year i

teach candidate teachers and it was completed by over 200 administrators this past school year the third source was tea data texas education agency this is a required survey since the campus administrators or principals for each teacher they have in our program and as noted on the final slide from tea we outperformed the state average on all accountability measures in texas

[07:17:48] the third document was a rebuttal to a study published in conjunction with the university of Texas. And I provided you a full response to that article, but also I provided you a summary sheet just to kind of calibrate some information about that study that was published by the University of Texas. Their claim and key recommendation was to create a more accessible and affordable university-based pathway to teacher certification. Some of the things worth noting in the study, though, is that study was solely conducted by members of institutes of higher education.

[07:18:23] No representative from non-traditional alternative certification was included in either the steering committee or the research team it's also worth noting the majority of alternative certification completers in the study were from a program called a plus texas teachers a plus texas teachers of tomorrow is currently on probation from the tea most recently they have filed an injunction or restraining order against the tea and the commissioner of education for them to not shut them down a state audit in 2021 found substantial issues with the operations of texas

[07:18:57] teachers of tomorrow it's also worth noting that they have not been able to successfully obtain cape accreditation based on their coursework rigor and quality other parts of the study to note that wasn't called out in the study was iTeach has trained nearly twice as many stem teachers as the university of texas has trained in total across all their content areas which is evidence that iTeach helps meet workforce demands when asked which alternative certification program administers prefer to hire in our survey 93 respond in iTeach and 97 percent of principals

[07:19:37] that have hired a teacher from iTeach would hire a teacher from iTeach again lastly iTeach maintains strict guidelines on constant area placement ensuring compatibility and success in the classroom while a plus Texas teachers allows for open placement regardless of degree college credit or experience which i believe skews the data and the performance outcome of those teachers when taking consideration how much of the population or sample size that study would have been from a plus texas teachers my conclusion in response to that study would be an agreement with

[07:20:14] the authors of the study on page three and kind of the opening salvo of the study fitzpatrick says undoubtedly there are highly effective university-based programs and highly effective alternative certification programs and i think the latter was referring to us this past monday we received notification from superintendent coons that another article has been has given cause for concern this article is a report from the learning policy institute titled strengthening pathways to the teaching profession in texas and i briefly would like to provide a response to that report dr linda

[07:20:53] darling hammond was the primary contributor to the study along with fellow stanford faculty member Jennifer Bland, and Steve Wojciechowicz, a VP at Deans for Impact. Like the University of Texas report, this study did not employ the perspective of any non-IHE alternative certification representative. Additionally, despite Dr. Darlene Hammond's vocal position against non-IHE alternative certification pathways, she is the author of another study called Reforming Teacher Preparation and Licensing: Debating the Evidence. In this study, she highlights the negative impact of teachers with zero training,

[07:21:31] which I feel is currently impacting many of the classrooms in Virginia. Further, she goes on in that study to praise programs that would earn CAPE accreditation, citing significant data showing increased teacher effectiveness from CAPE accredited programs. The LPI study highlighted three issues currently facing teachers in Texas.

[07:21:51] One, several times in the study, the study mentions funding. Two, the need for teachers growing due to growth in the state and attrition. and three growing reliance on alternative certification programs unfortunately i do not have much control over the funding issue but it's worth noting that i teach does not operate based on available funding from state or federal government i can speak to however the issues of attrition and the reliance on certification programs the authors of the study argue that relying on alternative certification programs is bad for a few reasons namely low program completion

[07:22:31] rates and high attrition rates. This report, like the University of Texas report, is highly skewed with the inclusion of Texas Teachers Data, the other program, with that program certifying over 60% of the teachers in the 2021 school year noted in the study. The good data of iTeach is overlooked or hidden in this study. In looking at the latest available data from TEA, the data shows that our five-year retention rate is 75%, which is the same as any university in Texas. In a recent

[07:23:05] study that we conducted of individuals finishing this school year right now 86 said they intend to be teaching within five years and 73 said that they intend to be teaching in 10 years perhaps more importantly 96 said that they are excited about a career in teaching towards noting that this is the end of their first year teaching this past school year 96 so they're excited about teaching. The same data from the TEA shows that our completion rate is 91 percent, which is well

[07:23:39] above the state average in Texas. Studies like those from UT and LPI serve to show opportunities for continual improvement across programs. For that, we welcome these studies and forthcoming studies to analyze how programs can train high quality teachers. However, we cannot accept all outcomes of these studies at face value without understanding the context in which they are written. We have always taken the position and we will continue to take the position of iTeach being an option for teachers. We sincerely believe that providing an option to train teachers will help attract new teachers and train new teachers in settings aligned to their learning

[07:24:17] style and their needs. Lastly, the fourth document provided to you is a coursework crosswalk showing the VA standards of PK-6 and the competencies of our coursework. And hopefully had a chance to see this document is about 27 pages but just to orient you to the structure of the document the first page is a summary the following 26 pages is a line by line look at how our course methodology lines up with the vac standards domains and competencies required for pk through six so on the summary sheet for instance one of the deficiencies articulated on the april

[07:24:57] agenda item was quote methods and teaching elementary mathematics course three semester hours that was noted as a deficiency in our application and then on the summary sheet we show that ccva 9003 teaching elementary math satisfies the requirements noted on the application that's high level we believe and we have evidence with the 25 pages that follow that that course teaching elementary math meets the methods of teaching elementary mathematics course we break down each of the deficiencies outlined in the april agenda and again dr anderson is here for

[07:25:33] questions if there's any arising from that crosswalk i've spent this entire time speaking to data sets reports studies and rebuttals all of these provide objective evidence that the i teach program is a high

quality program that produces effective teachers that remain in the classroom perhaps what could be missed in the formal application or these board meetings is what i would call the tough to quantify components of our program for instance dr huber here the founder of i teach she's my mom she created i teach because she was a single mother of four boys and wanted

[07:26:09] to provide an accessible and affordable option to those like her who wanted to teach and perhaps something else not articulated here is that i'm a certified high school math teacher and if you were to call the i teach offices right now you have a good chance that you'll talk to another certified teacher who has lived experiences in the classroom and the help that our team provides new teachers is from lived experiences, not some sort of onboarding or training from ITeach.

[07:26:37] We know the teaching profession is hard, especially the first year, but we have a commitment and we feel a burden for kids to have a great teacher. In fact, just last night I was sitting next to my mom. She was on the phone, it was 8 p.m. and she was talking to one of our team members. She was reminding them that the standard we hold our teachers to cannot be compromised.

[07:26:58] By compromising on the quality that we hold them to is a disservice not just to that teacher, but also to their students in many ways we feel like the underdog of teacher cert and certainly an outsider from universities but is this perspective that we welcome scrutiny data reports and studies in fact we proactively requested the louisiana board of education to be included in their teacher effectiveness data which we weren't originally part of we want to highlight the hard work that we get the privilege to engage in i appreciate you listening to me this afternoon providing my team the opportunity to address the board's questions we are committed to working with

[07:27:36] this board to continually improve our coursework and ensure alignment of standards might evolve we're happy to answer any other questions the board might have about the application or the i teach component of the division's applications thank you thank you very much would it be helpful to call my team forward to answer questions you are welcome to call

[07:27:54] them forward and we'll see what questions come that's great thank you welcome to all of you and again thanks for being with us and we apologize for the delay does the board have any uh questions - I did, I have to scoot up, Anne, if I may, for a meeting.

[07:28:30] I just wanted to quickly ask on the crosswalk, thank you for all that you put together to help us further understand the information that was shared in April, but on the crosswalk, was that something that was actually included with the application that you submitted?

[07:28:46] I'm just curious if the department had access to your lining up your courses against our standards the decisions they came back with i just i'm i was just curious about that one piece the crosswalk was not part of the original application okay when it came to our attention that that would be helpful we had aligned our professional studies courses with the crosswalk and then the department came back and asked for an alignment of our elementary and at that time dr gaffney and dr

[07:29:21] anderson uh prepared the crosswalk i'm not sure the exact date it was submitted but it was it has been submitted that was out of the first working session some of the questions and things you wanted um in follow-up so after that meeting we submitted that i think a couple of weeks ago you got the crosswalk and gave i teach plenty of time to make sure that they did a detailed crosswalk for you the staff had an opportunity to look at that since it was resubmitted

[07:29:53] briefly again we are we are missing we are our educator prep team is is we are rebuilding and really focused on making sure all those licensures go out july 1st so they have not done a deep deep dive analysis but they have done a review of that result may i just follow up as to that and it may be to you dr coons and or uh thank you mr rosell and team the presentation but you know i'm just

[07:30:24] Marguerite McLaughlin: reluctant to substitute my judgment for the experts on the course crosswalk issue what I see is we have we had an expert panel and department staff give us a recommendation, and now we're hearing that they didn't have all the information.

[07:30:41] Marguerite McLaughlin: So i'd be very interested in you know, this is a big enough and important enough decision that i'd like to make sure we get the either get back to the panel on it or get to your staff at least. sure and tell us you know what's there because i just can't read those 20 i mean i appreciate that you've given it to us but it's beyond my expertise to evaluate those 27 pages of crosswalk as to the course content well and i teach has talked about the quality and the level of rigor of review in other states and kind of that feedback i would be very interested in an opportunity for us to implement their crosswalk and then review it yearly and review the data that comes out of that

[07:31:20] to make sure as we're learning that crosswalk to the virginia standards because we can all talk about it in a theoretical approach but really having the opportunity to implement it and review it every year and review the data that comes out of our i teach staff across the state would allow us to have empirical evidence about whether or not that crosswalk is actually working and that is the recommendation of the staff from this morning does that mean that we should start with the requirement of the additional in other words you know the staff's recommendation that we the staff's recommendation no the staff's recommendation is that we review the competencies at the end of each year and make decisions on a year-to-year basis but i mean the recommendation

[07:32:00] we had from them at the last meeting was that we follow the panel's recommendation that teachers completing the iTeach program would some of the elementary teachers would be required to take additional coursework based on their review this morning was that we go ahead and look at competencies versus requiring additional coursework so they would they've changed their recommendations since we were together last time that is correct based on the crosswalk based on the additional crosswalk they are appreciative of the additional information but want to

[07:32:36] gut check the empirical evidence of the competencies each year to make sure we're meeting the expectations and we'll be able to hear from them tomorrow i do not believe they are in this state for them to hear but i'm happy to speak on their behalf as their superintendent that was that was helpful thank you for thank you for that okay let me uh i don't see anybody else jumping up so normally i wait till the end but i do i do have others i know but let me you know talk in my sort of non-educator language for a minute you'll forgive me all right let me tell

[07:33:12] you my concerns and hopefully you can address them and they're not so much with i teach directly as conceptually with where we're headed in the commonwealth with regard to you know teachers in teaching quality right we are clearly you know post-pandemic facing you know critical shortfall in the number of educators and so there is a lot of pressure on the board on the system right to create new licensed teachers and we are comfortable with the idea that a licensed teacher coming

[07:33:47] through any of the alternative programs is better than you know just putting long-term subs in the classrooms in terms of student outcomes so that that's not really an issue what worries me a little bit is

and again you mentioned the texas study and you say well uh and i i actually believe that you're accurate in this that you do it better than the other company whose data is included all right so this is not a question of gee i don't believe that what worries me is that at some point in the lifetime of i teach or let me phrase it another way how do i as a board member

[07:34:25] and how does the commonwealth ensure that the same quality standards you have now that separates you from other providers remain through the the tenure of your time in virginia because you know if in texas the data i saw said you know i don't know uh one in four teachers is now coming through a for-profit you know licensing company uh since 2009 i think was the data so more and more there's a substantial portion that makes sense right because if you can do it uh less expensively and get people jobs people will come to the less expensive alternative but if you're also less

[07:35:05] effective in terms of your teaching capability and again i'm not saying i teach is that's not my point but if the for-profit providers in general are less effective aren't we then essentially facing the possibility of a teaching force over time that is less effective than the university educated teaching force that you know the commonwealth is looking to have and so the question is if you were me and said and looked at you guys and said we believe we're different and we believe

[07:35:41] items one two three four five make us different how do we condition the application or the conduct of iTeach so that we can ensure that quality stays over the corporate lifetime because you know I'm a business guy right and you know over time a lot of corporations in order you know they begin to cut costs begin to cut training you know we're for profit uh clearly you know it's in your current corporate culture not to do that but you guys you know won't be there forever either so what do you put on uh restriction wise what makes you different from the group in texas that is

[07:36:21] you know now under you know suspension or whatever the correct phrase is i apologize for the long sort of meandering question but i think i hope you understand sort of the gist of what i'm looking for i want to take the first stab uh president gecker and if i stumble my colleagues uh and my on i will say just let me just our remark if i had ever referred to my mother as part of my team i would not still be here i am in shock and awe that you got away with it

[07:36:55] yeah there you go yeah so i've been with it for 17 years so we've perfected this uh relationship to an extent i think my first you got response to you is that i don't think we're at the level of quality we want to be at yet so when we speak of differentiation from a plus texas teachers tomorrow and there's concern of how do we keep the quality going that's not where my initial mind goes right off the bat it's we still have a lot more program quality to achieve first before i'm worried about any kind of degradation of the quality so we voluntarily submit to to deac to

[07:37:29] cape to quality matters and so we are continually strengthening the way in which we we look at quality the way we differentiate ourselves from the market for a value add proposition but we also like i mentioned my opening remarks feel incumbent on us to go above and beyond we can't do the bare minimum we have to go above and beyond for the sake of consumer protection and consumer trust as well as the board trust i think to another point though and and i don't say i'm putting the cart before the horse perhaps but as of today we started the process of filing to become a b corp

[07:38:05] corporation and so we we say a lot of things in our core values and our mission statements um but but we're at a position in our company to actually take action on that so that we will be refiling our llc under a b corp which hopefully y'all are aware of the the strings attached to that to make sure that we're

walking what we're saying and so those are my initial thoughts on when i think of the longevity of making sure that there's not a complacency that's where i come from i also i'm looking to do this for a long time and i have three little boys and so each day i wake up from a missional standpoint i want them to have a good teacher so i feel a personal conviction

[07:38:42] to ensure that that my sons and their peers have access to high quality teaching but if i missed something and i am dying in at work but never outside those doors it would really confuse on grandchildren i do want to say first of all that one way you know is through cape we were the first non-institution of higher ed to apply to cape and i just assumed that all the other alternative programs would also do it because if diane can do it we can do it so now all these years later

[07:39:20] i teach is still the only nationally accredited programs or cape that shows our determination to be good the other point we can't lose sight of um is that this isn't our application this is the division and and travis can speak to this we are partnering with divisions across the commonwealth if the division doesn't like what we are doing then they don't use us anymore so we are bound by our agreement and commitment to the divisions you are approving division applications to partner

[07:40:00] with i teach so there's a built-in uh oversight the state the division and i teach so one of the things you mentioned then let me just is cape so if there were a requirement for example that you stay cape certified would that be something antithetical to where you'd want to be oh absolutely okay just it just feels polite to ask if i could bring up all the states that

[07:40:31] i teach has worked with we operate at the pleasure of the state board in all of our states and we want to make sure whatever changes in rural legislation we will comply with to ensure that we align with what the board has established and i guess what i'm looking for you to help with is again let's assume next month you know texas was a plus texas i forget what the name is texas teachers etc it doesn't matter let's assume they came here and said we're going to do a plus virginia and we look and say you know a lot of that texas data is because you guys weren't quite

[07:41:11] good enough uh what would you put in place for them that ensure that you know for our board that their teacher quality was sufficient for the commonwealth well you could put in rules and legislation the state of alabama just passed an extensive rule it passed last tuesday i believe that's to allow alternative programs to come into the state they set criterias of that you have to have been in existence 10 years you have to be approved in five other states you cannot be on

[07:41:49] probation in any state in which you operate so you have the authority to set your guidelines and set your bar and i would encourage you to visit with divisions that they also set their bar to align with high quality highly effective programs i appreciate those answers very much thank you mr hanson appreciate your comments mr president i just one thing i would say in just in terms of the traditional route for certification through the universities i remember what the date is but i

[07:42:26] think the average college graduate is going to change jobs eight times during their career and i also just think that the traditional system as we know it people are making decisions when they're 18 to 25 when they're going through to be a teacher we need people who are deciding to be teacher when they're 25 35 45 and so we need to have a robust system that will accommodate those people so that we're not just relying on people when they're 18 years old that this is a career pathway they want to go but that we've got a pliable rigorous system to have the on-ramps

[07:43:04] to the different pathways that people are going to want to go and so i just um think that working these public private partnerships is critically important and um and i appreciate the comments you made about your business or tax structure or whatever and i just sometimes feel like we shouldn't get hot up too much in that because we frankly again need an all-of-the-above strategy on our approach to certification and filling just the incredible pipeline needs that we're going to have

[07:43:39] advocate high quality teachers in our schools and um and our universities our state governments local governments everybody relies on different types of providers to come in and partner with them whether it's on their facilities or their services or whatever it might be so i um and i just maybe just a quick question too just right now even virginia from a reciprocity standpoint i would imagine we're already certifying teachers coming from your other 11 states i don't know if

[07:44:16] there's any data about that or whatever but the two things that give me comfort is that we are already in this reciprocity arena with those 11 states and we also talk a lot of this board level that we want to rely upon local control and with the 22 districts asking for this i think we really need to put our trust in them of them knowing what types of teachers they need they're the ones making the decisions on who they're hiring why they're hiring them and what skills and abilities that they have to come in to their system but i i just don't know if there's

[07:44:56] any data you might have on the reciprocity just even maybe at a high level well i did look at that in anticipation of the question all of the out-of-state transfers from i teach for the last 20 years have come across my desk i haven't completed one for virginia so i'm sorry to say but i did look at your reciprocity requirements our program because we're cape accredited all of our candidates would be accepted into the state based on they're coming from a cape accredited

[07:45:30] entity it's crazy sorry i got your secret first then miss crazy okay yeah um so i'm one of the people who was concerned about the sole source uh procurement language and i'd like to elaborate on that you even put in as one of the safeguards in your program is that these are the divisions that are asking and it's their applications etc but i don't think it should be whether or not you're a large division with an in-house legal team or if you're a small division who has to rely on external resources um again considering the fact that you outlined that it's up to the division side they

[07:46:05] want to use you then i still take issue with a non-compete 24-month clause because with the quality being what it is and to be clear i support high quality options uh for teachers to answer the call to teach and enter the profession um and because i support options i don't support uh contract language that makes one the only option and so that that i just i have you so i'm glad you made provisos for the divisions who had legal teams and said hey strike that because again a good legal team should say strike that sole source they say oh virginia courts are going to handle disputes there's some things that that you know an in-house legal team will do that again

[07:46:41] smaller rural divisions um i i think is part of this process and part of your commitment to excellence um that shouldn't be up to whether or not there's a deep legal team in the division it's crazy so um i'm really interested in both recruitment and retention of teachers that's a huge issue across the country as you all well know and a lot of that oftentimes particularly in our career switcher programs and and our pre-service and early service teachers

[07:47:19] really depends on excellent mentorship and clinical placement hours talk to me a little bit about what clinical placement hours looks like in some of your states that you have broader full-scale

teacher prep programs for number one and number two what does the mentor program look like that you all are supporting here in the partnership divisions that you already work with in virginia amy can you lead out on uh the 5700 and uh support in the classroom during clinical

[07:47:57] absolutely once our candidates are hired they are assigned a supervisor and enter a course called 5700 that supervisor is very supportive and visits them in the field and observes them teaching live at least five times and gives them feedback pre-observation and post-observation feedback on a rubric that is aligned to the in task standards and this mentorship is ends up being a really lovely bond between the supervisor and the candidate providing them a lot of mentorship and quite a bit of support in the field where the supervisors coming from well they're they're

[07:48:34] regionally located so right now i'm speaking of 5700 in texas specifically and so they live close to them because they have to go to that school so i guess my i guess i should have worded that differently are you contracting with these supervisors so are they working for you all so they are not they are not currently um working in a school in a re in a division within the region okay no they're not most of them are retired superintendents or principals or education professionals and just just to maybe add some clarification around texas specifically um texas

[07:49:13] administrative code requires for an individual to be observed a minimum of three times by the program supervisor we do a minimum of five and that's uncapped as well so if a teacher needs additional opportunities with the supervisor then the supervisor will go back onto campus as many times as needed if there's any deficiency plans needed to be created or how that looks and then another example in louisiana louisiana administrative code says that the supervising team which consists of cooperating teacher mentor teacher principal and program supervisor that team of four is required to complete at least three supervisions collectively across

[07:49:52] two semesters we hold to the five observations ourselves in louisiana and so um we will conduct at least five observations over the course of two semesters in louisiana which is well above the minimum for the louisiana administrative code we also work cooperatively with the mentor teacher so when we get the documentation that someone's been hired they get assigned a supervisor supervisor goes on to campus to meet with the administrator and to procure who the cooperating or mentor teacher is on campus if that mentor teacher needs any additional support or onboarding for some orientation we also provide a course for our mentor teachers some states actually have

[07:50:32] a mentor teacher license which kind of substitutes our need to enter into that for instance louisiana has a mentor teacher license that's an actual status within the state so we we work with with however the state is set up whether it be a mentor teacher cooperating teachers administrators but the the roots the foundation is our contracted supervisors we currently contract a little over 200 contractors right now our supervisor to student

[07:51:01] ratio is 11 to 1 in terms of students to supervisors so in virginia would the supervisors be be superintendents principals that are certified in virginia or would they be from outside of virginia yeah that's a good question for the division partners as we're not taking lead in the clinical placement field experience residency component of the process so if if you have if you would like mr holder he can maybe address that more

[07:51:36] specifically i can also speak into it from speaking with all the different divisions they have their own plan division by division to support the i teach teachers and they will use the cape accredited

evaluation form that is provided part of the application and so a principal in that current school because after all these are their teachers right and so they're going to do the evaluation of them using the virginia standards using the virginia requirements and then they will fill out the cape accredited form three times and that will be part of their

[07:52:15] file for licensure so they will to answer your question yes they will be virginia people they will be in their own schools uh the principals the coaches whoever's doing the evaluations and then that will be they will use the i teach cape accredited form to be part of the file and travis here has spoken a lot about what his plan is for the new teachers and for the i teach teachers but i can tell you each division that i've worked with has a plan in place and several of them will come tomorrow and share that with you because i i recognized last time when maggie

[07:52:53] shared that not every application had a laid out plan and that was never addressed to us and that would have been helpful so they're going to share that with you because as a principal i can tell you that it would be a major concern and so i like the way i teach is partnering and i like the way the divisions get to make it their own and these are their employees superintendent coons yeah my team is not here in virginia but i am chatting with them um they stated that to their knowledge they don't know of anyone who's come from texas out of the i teach that has come through on

[07:53:30] alternative license so they checked there's no way for our current system as we've talked about our current system is clunky we will be able to do that starting in september but there is no way for us to be able to determine that in place our team has stated that they are willing if this board so chooses to put in place an annual review of mentoring programs an annual review of competencies and things like that our team has volunteered to do anything like that if the board so chooses to ask us to do that yes thank you all uh mr roselline team for your presentations i

[07:54:08] i was the one who was particularly asking questions about uh uh completion and retention rates uh based on my read of the texas study and i understand the data there was skewed by this other provider and so i'm very grateful and your representation today that your retention rates are higher than the texas average and your completion rates higher than the texas average is uh extremely helpful can we get that can we get documentation of that quickly i mean in times for our consideration tomorrow can you just send us the basis for your what you told us here today

[07:54:40] about your retention and completion yes thank you uh and then my my next uh um uh set of questions is about what what miss creasy raised about as i understand this supervisor i mean this five times a year that's a supervisor that's an observer for the ultimate licensure process but but the mentorship is much more intense i would hope um and on the ground right but as i understand it and i may be entirely wrong about this and your staff be able to help us on this but virginia's

[07:55:16] minimum required minimum Virginia does have minimum requirements for mentorships but they're very vague and interpreted and implemented quite differently across our divisions we've got some that just do top of the line work on mentorship I call it the Hanover model because I have familiarity with that fairly well here but I don't know that you know there may be other divisions doing equally high quality but the two to me the two it's extremely important for these provisional licensees who are coming through without having done student teaching

[07:55:52] beforehand and as i understand that the clinical placement is essentially waived for most of these teachers on provisional licensees so the mentor coaching relationship is the the substitute for that

and as i understand from the research from lpi and elsewhere that that that component is extremely important to these teachers ultimate success and to me the two criteria that would i would love to have us put as a condition on the application and i'd ask for your help on the wording on that would one be that the mentoring relationship be not just one year it'd be an ongoing i think three years is probably the right standard but i'd be interested in your

[07:56:31] opinion or you know input on that and and and or maybe the fairfax um you know representative would have can tell us what they're doing or what their suggestions might be but and then second that there be dedicated a minimum dedicated amount of time for them so i hear you know 11 to 1 student well that's 11 to 1 probably would be adequate if it is full-time dedicated but i'm not sure that's what you're talking about so if if you have a mentor who has no other job responsibilities other than supervising 10 say teachers new brand new teachers who've never been in the classroom

[07:57:09] before never had any clinical experience before if they're mentoring 10 teachers and not doing anything else then that means they've got four hours a week to spend with those teachers that to me something like that would be about the minimum and they might spend more with the brand new teachers and less with the year two and year three teachers say but uh so help me with how how

[07:57:32] How does one go about saying we want a high, if we wanted to condition these applications on the divisions having in place a high quality coaching mentorship partnership, a plan in place, how would we describe that?

[07:57:51] And then, you know, if we put that condition in place and then have the division be able to monitor it, that would, that would help me immensely. it might be helpful and forgive my ignorance on this uh is this currently set up for universities to complete and can we borrow the language that universities use for multi-year mentorship and dedicated models i don't know that we have anything i mean the universities are mostly doing the the student teaching model where they're getting their clinical work pre i don't know maybe there is i i shouldn't answer what i know i can send you some model things if that would be helpful we've got some from some school divisions that do some exemplary programs if you'd like me to

[07:58:30] and you i actually think your partner one of your um proposed contracts is with henrico henrico has language similar to what miss holton is talking about so you could give us some language and and so then my question to you would be is there any reason why we can't condition the approval would you have any feedback for us on potentially conditioning the approval of these applications on such a high quality mentorship program being in place in the division i don't know if it would be under our purview from i teach to speak on behalf of divisions if they're the ones

[07:59:06] putting forth a three-year relationship for mentoring i don't feel comfortable i'm just asking if if we on our action tomorrow or whenever we make it put that condition in does i teach have any input or feedback for us one way or the other on that it seems like a large ask for divisions but again if they're if they're already doing similar things then maybe it's a division by division request i think the answer will be some are already doing it and some are not and so then my question to you from my teachers perspective is there from your assessment of

[07:59:40] what's necessary to get good teachers is there a reason why we shouldn't do that in the 11 states we've we've approved been approved for and the four pending there has not been a consideration by any department for a three-year or multi-year initial certification program going into the induction

onboarding that that far i will say my three-year i'm not saying that that's what the you know what dr coons's folks will come up with in terms of what i'm saying a high quality mentorship program with dedicated time is what i'm looking for but whether that whether it's

[08:00:16] two or three years you know i don't or what i don't know but the uh i i would be interested in your thoughts on whether and for teachers who haven't done haven't had any clinical experience am i right that the research says high quality mentorship is is an important component of their success absolutely a couple of points to that if i might is that um first of all in our app or in the applications before you there is a complete collaboration between i teach providing

[08:00:50] coursework and the districts doing the mentorship so i can address andrew can address what we do in other states but i don't think we can speak since it's a collaboration to reduce cost to serve the individuals and the majority of individuals we're looking to address are those on provisional licenses who have already taught one two or three years and who need to get that certification so we depend upon our partners whether it be fairfax or whatever division to do the mentoring

[08:01:26] because they're their employees so i did read i mean reading through the 130 whatever that's not right 60 applications i did not read every single word but i did skim through them and i saw broad-based vague one-line assertions we'll have a high quality we'll have a mentor program in place and that was all they said um maybe one or two of them had more but i didn't see anything that gave me the assurances i needed in the applications we have before us today well good afternoon members

[08:02:03] of the board dr coons um mr gecker um so our initial application was the main basis for it obviously was the fact that this organization is cape accredited and i appreciate the comments about a conditional requirement that that i teach maintain cape accreditation when it comes to the mentorship excuse me the mentorship piece our current um application is the intent is to leverage our existing mentorship and induction programs and again every school division is is different

[08:02:37] with different resources but um that was our again the basis of our application was to utilize our existing structures our mentorships leveraging the the supervisors that i teach would contract certainly if if the thinking or the direction is that we have more than one year i mean that's why we brought this to the board because ultimately the legislation allowed school divisions to

[08:03:12] put an application using the system that would be reviewed by a panel and um brought to the board for for approval or whatever the case may be so you know i i think the main thing we were looking at from our division standpoint is um accessibility opportunities um how can we and this is the analogy i keep using how can we add one more item to the menu so to speak for folks to come into into education um we were aware of other um organizations that were referenced today and

[08:03:50] again we we did not intentionally go down that road um primarily because of the cape accreditation so that that is i i can't i guess emphasize that enough is that that's the the differentiator if you will and certainly the assurances that we're hearing that the intent is that they maintain cape accreditation um i i had the honor of working at mason george mason for five years going through in cape and cape accreditation so i'm i'm familiar i don't know the extent of which i teach had to go through that i would be personally i think that's something for the board to consider as well but

[08:04:30] for sustained and long-term mentorship and um excuse me um internship again that that's something we could explore if that's that's the a condition of the application and and to diane's point if

that's something we would have to um i'd say we would have to modify some of our structures of our existing uh mentorship programs you're perfect yes ma'am can you tell us what your existing mentorship program is and in particular how much dedicated time for provisional licensee i i will

[08:05:09] try to do it justice um it is called great beginnings um we have a team that leads that we have um site-based mentors and excuse me we have um so the site-based mentors are mentor teachers they are provided stipends to provide that ongoing um in the building mentorship we also have local um i can't think of the exact word but we have folks within our we have region structures folks who are lead mentors who oversee um the site-based mentors and then from there

[08:05:46] it's scaffolded up to um division mentors um we we and again i i'll be honest with you i would not do it justice but but we do get a lot of it's one of our selling points for um recruiting folks even new to the profession from even local universities that they they have the opportunity to get that mentorship in their first year we require even veteran teachers new to the division to go through some type of mentorship also and it's a one-year program it is a one-year program

[08:06:23] additionally to show the importance of the district partnership the division is the recommending entity to the department of ed for certification it is not i teach this is a division application and they will be the the recommending entities is my understanding from the department okay let's do this because we're going to wrap this particular presentation up fairly soon got dr siebert mr rotherham miss creasy and then unless somebody just really really really needs

[08:06:57] to talk we're going to let the math team do their thing today too about that but dr siever yeah i just you know to my colleague i'd like to say i appreciate the emphasis on the importance of quality mentorship um i think as you know as the department looks at this i would encourage us not to over engineer or over require because what large divisions are able to bring to bear they need to bring to bear at an engineer level because of the scale but scalability in a small rural division can be incredibly powerful with a director of instruction from a central office providing that kind of oversight and coaching um you know in my 15 year superintendent i personally observed

[08:07:36] every new teacher at least once during their their first year now again you can't do that in giant divisions um but i mean some years that was quite a few people so i just wanted to say whatever processes are let's not hitch it to something over engineered let's really focus on scalability because again our smaller rural divisions can have an intimacy of support for teachers that can be incredibly powerful okay mr rotherham hi thanks so much um so i just have a couple questions um i i enjoy i like this i'm i i will show my cards like nkk accreditation don't i mean

[08:08:13] they don't carry a lot of weight with me there's not a lot of evidence that they produce any kind of effect it's an input driven process and some of the data you share with us is pretty input driven as well i'm wondering are there any studies i mean given that you know we know when you look across teacher prep and pretty much any route the except for sort of you know emergency credentials the variance is greater among candidates than between the roots so it's a little bit of a it's it's a it's a noisy sector and the questions but do you guys have any evidence that you can share with us you know any kind of of tier one evidence controlled any kind of controlled experiment

[08:08:50] analysis anything like that that you could share on effectiveness if teachers have gone through i teach relative to other routes i mean i share the concerns about the texas study and so that was also like you know kind of a whatever but what do you all have positively that we can say so my my response would

probably be twofold because i appreciate the question one there's objective data coming out of louisiana about looking at teacher effectiveness tied back to the program from the board of regents right louisiana state university i provided some of the overview about the teacher effectiveness data i think secondly there there might be an appreciation of funding

[08:09:25] allocation where universities might have grant money and funding for tier one research that would fund research about university programs or like i've stated exclude alternative for-profit certification our program in virginia would be priced at around three thousand dollars unfortunately that doesn't give me a ton of excess capital to go fund a research project we have talked internally about prioritizing that um to see if a third party could be funded external from us to validate some of this because i think what you're tapping on is some of our frustration that has been going on for

[08:10:01] for many years to try to get uh external third party validated data that equates fairly universities to non-traditional routes well and the good news for us if we want to think about is right here at the university of virginia we have some of the leading national researchers on these questions like jim wake off for instance is there and so like it seems like uh it seems like the ability and that kind of tees up like two other questions one for the for the board could you summarize the louisiana data what is that what does that show sure so they do they do a very good job of measuring hey andy can i respond to the exceptional educator prep universities and uva before you

[08:10:40] respond to that we have had conversations currently we don't have the data on the programming because of the paper system but we're really excited in september in our in our conversations with uva about some of those studies at the department level so i just wanted to flag that actually why don't we you're anticipating another question which was could you just talk a little more about what we should expect by way of quality assurance sure so one we're happy to submit any data to any entity for the validation of the quality that we're doing we have no qualms or hesitations around that to answer your second question then getting back to quality matters uh state of louisiana uses a scoring system called compass they use that tool to track student

[08:11:19] effectiveness back to teacher preparation if you look at the disaggregated data they measure four items on the compass in terms of teacher effectiveness and we score at least as good as any other route both private for-profit traditional and post-bac it's not the easiest data to to aggregate but on the board of regents website it shows every program their report card And so it's relatively easy to see what our scoring on the compass is compared to LSU or LRC or the other programs there.

[08:11:48] - Okay, and then just backing up, you said like about quality assurance, you said you'd be happy to look at any data. Do you all do any quality assurance? Like what should we be expecting if you're in Virginia? - That's interesting. In Texas, it is very in the assurance.

[08:12:04] And I was just at a conference with Maggie Clements, introduced her to our statistician and quality assurance from Texas to line Maggie up to see if Virginia could not replicate some of the things we're doing in Texas to give the board back quality data. I just want to speak again. We don't have a licensure system that would track how a teacher is licensed currently in the state of Virginia. That is the hang up with tracking the data and part of the licensure revision process that we are doing in Virginia we are at least 10

[08:12:40] years behind on how we track licensure processes so if Mr. Gecker went through iTeach and I went through UVA say we wouldn't know that in the licensure system we have no way to track that

currently we are launching that in September that's what I was saying to Andy is we are we are at the precipice of being able to know how our teachers are licensed to then track impact data but in virginia currently we have not been able to track that in the system that's why i can't tell you how many educators have come from texas from an alternative program at this point in time so we're getting there but we would love to be able to do those

[08:13:19] things but we are not we are not fundamentally tracking the right kind of data yet to be able to do that but we'll be able to do that starting in september all right thank you thanks for being here um yeah so fine and jumping into the the cape accreditation piece just a couple of questions on that what's your review cycle what's your year year next review is in 20 uh 27 20 27 and how long is that that uh cycle for you seven it's not just first that is the cape uh just making sure that

[08:13:52] it's not different for no um additionally so do any of when a cape accreditation team does your review do they send any observers into classrooms where any of your students are teaching absolutely a whole team comes in and they spend three days going out looking at schools to see that uh classroom interaction they interview our current candidates they interview our graduates they interview superintendents hrs it's a very detailed interview okay the first time we had our cape

[08:14:30] accreditation cape gives afis areas for improvement and our first accreditation we had no afis identified on our last review the afi was to develop uh relationships for student teaching placements and that was the only afi we had in our last review thank you i just wanted to clarify that thank you okay i think everybody's had a chance to ask some questions we have a few other things we need to do today again let me express the thanks to the board to y'all for being here

[08:15:05] i think you understand that you know we are concerned about the data uh you mentioned coming in in the texas study for example the other group dragged the numbers down that implies that you know your numbers out of that study can you bring those numbers absolutely thank you and uh that's it we'll see you all tomorrow thank you very much thank you very much okay proposed proposed revisions

[08:15:33] to the math standards of learning dr alvin i just want to say a personal thank you for dr alvin i think he's done more stairs today checking on our timeline in the past six months are you gonna let him use the elevator i tried to get him on the elevator earlier today all 23 floors yeah there

[08:16:08] you go we've been waiting for this for months so we're ready good we're excited good morning president gecko vice president man uh superintendent coons and members of the board um we do have a presentation to share with you today and we do feel it's important for us to take the time to do this with you today because we do expect with any revision of new standards there will be a lot of public interest we need a lot of public disclosure as well as an opportunity tomorrow

[08:16:43] we expect there to be a lot of feedback on what we have already to share so my name is dr brendan Albon, I'm the Director of the Office of STEM and Innovation and joining me today I am honored to introduce our Coordinator of Mathematics, Ms. Tina Mazza-Kane, Specialist Ms. Kristen Williams-Fauss, Ms. Deborah DeLoja and Dr. Jessica Brown. Today we come to you as mathematicians, long time ago this is what I taught, as well as educators to share with you a draft of the 2023 Mathematics

[08:17:18] standards of learning for first review tomorrow so the updated standards documents along with detailed documents that provide a summary of the proposed changes to the current 2016 mathematics standards of learning will be presented the objective of today's presentation will be to

provide an overview of the organization of the mathematics standards of learning Specify the timeline for the 2023 Mathematics Standards of Learning revision process.

[08:17:51] Review draft documents of the 2023 Mathematics Standards of Learning and highlight examples of some of the changes incorporated in these proposed standards. And also to describe the supports for implementation for the 2023 Mathematics Standards of Learning. So the revised Mathematics SOLs that will be presented today represent the best in class for all students across the Commonwealth of Virginia. The revisions to the standards involve the engagement of a very,

[08:18:29] very broad array of stakeholders, including parents, K-12 educators, faculty from institutions of higher education, and community and business members. By providing clear and vertically coherent set of expectations to educators and families. The revisions to the standards will raise academic expectations for all students and schools in Virginia. Instruction based on rigorous academic content standards will ensure that students have access to educational experiences

[08:19:06] that prepare them for successful post-secondary opportunities. The Draft 2023 Mathematics standards of learning establish clear and coherent standards that allow for common expectations of proficiency for students families school staff as well as assessment designers so based on the standards of quality the board of education shall establish a regular schedule for the review and revision of all of standards of learning in all areas this review shall occur once at least every

[08:19:43] seven years so here we are mathematics is now up to the plate there are 19 sets of standards representing the nine elementary and middle grades k through eight three high school mathematics courses with end of course assessments and an additional seven high school mathematics courses these are the sol courses that are taught in virginia and as you know these are not the only mathematics courses that are taught in Virginia. School divisions do have the ability to teach

[08:20:21] advanced placement courses through college board, dual enrollment, international baccalaureate or any other nationally SCED accredited courses. It is very important for us also to note that as you are aware school divisions do have the discretion of when to accelerate students into courses appropriate to their needs so in january of 2022 the board received the revision process timeline and we're going to share this graphic with you which kind of tells you where we are

[08:20:57] along that timeline so in light blue you will see what happened right after that period of time input on the 2016 mathematics standards of learning was received stakeholder feedback was collected beginning in february 2022 when written public input on the existing 2016 mathematics sols was accepted for 30 days provided public engagement sessions both in person and virtually throughout may and june of 2022. feedback on the draft 2023 mathematics sol

[08:21:36] is shown in gray once rough once a rough draft of the 2023 math sol were created small groups of stakeholders were convened and provided initial feedback those in-person and virtual meetings were held with parents k-12 educators faculty from institutions of higher ed and business community members in november and december the feedback on the draft of the 2023 mathematics sols were also received from educators at several state mathematics conferences written

[08:22:12] expert feedback was also sought on the initial drafts of the 2023 mathematics SOLs. So today we find ourselves moving from the gray to the dark blue. After this board will receive for first review the proposed mathematics standards, we will then move into another phase of receiving feedback. There will

be online written feedback from the public collected between June and August of 2023 pending the board's approval. Additionally, the board will hold several public hearings at

[08:22:47] which stakeholders will be able to provide comments regarding the draft 2023 mathematics SOLs. That's the fun part for you guys. So this timeline provides more detailed outline of the revision process which includes the opportunities for stakeholder input and feedback as shown throughout the slides broken down through periods of time. In addition to the public comment in February 2022, the public engagement sessions held in May and June of 2022, a mathematics education advisory

[08:23:23] committee was formed, which was composed of a diverse group of stakeholders. It was convened during June 2022 to serve in an advisory capacity during the revision process by analyzing all of the stakeholder feedback, some of which I have told you about and some of which I will share shortly, to see how those were implemented in the 2023 mathematics SOLs. During the summer of 2022, a review committee of 72 K-12 educators, which included a lead reviewer from each mathematics

[08:23:59] grade or course, was convened to create a draft of the process. The advisory committee then met again on September 2022 to review the draft standards and again in December to review feedback from external stakeholder groups that met through December and November.

[08:24:20] So staff at the Virginia Department of Education worked at the beginning of January 2023 to prepare the draft 2023 Mathematics Standards of Learning. We also developed summary documents which are available to you and the public, which provide an overview of the changes being proposed in the standards for each grade and course level.

[08:24:44] So we are pleased to be here as a team in June, not July, as it says, unfortunately, to present these draft documents for your review and for your approval, which you will get to determine tomorrow. Also begin to seek public feedback on these draft SOLs.

[08:25:03] And as mentioned earlier, this feedback will include opportunities to submit written feedback and public hearings. It is anticipated that the Board of Education will receive a revised version of the Draft 2023 SOLs in August or September.

[08:25:20] So as mentioned earlier, a Mathematics Education Advisory Committee was convened to analyze stakeholder feedback, review the Draft 2023 SOLs, and to provide recommendations regarding proposed changes to the standards.

[08:25:37] group of stakeholders is met three times during the revision process and are expected to convene again following the public hearings that the board will hear so i know it's rather small but this slide does give you an idea of who serves on the mathematics education advisory committee you'll notice that there are k-12 educators which go all the way from special education to core content all the way to gifted education and governance school teachers we've got people who represent higher education, we also have people who represent parent-teacher associations,

[08:26:15] and we also have people who represent industry. These are the people essentially who have listened to the public input that we've received and are ensuring that the public's voice is being heard in these written standards. So during the public comment period seeking the input on the current 2016 Mathematics Standards of Learning, the Department of Education received 141 submissions.

[08:26:48] Of these, 138 were general comments about the standards not specifically targeting a specific grade or level, while over 200 comments included more grade-specific comments. During the public engagement sessions held in May and June of 2022, there were 174 attendees who provided 432 comments regarding the 2016 math SOLs. In addition, 480 attendees consisting of parents, K-12 educators, faculty from institutions of higher ed, community and

[08:27:24] business leaders had the opportunity to provide over 809 comments regarding the 2016 math SOLs. subject matter experts were also consulted regarding the revision of the sols which included content professors professors who design who design and instruct in teacher preparation programs as well as child development experts several leaders from state math organizations provided feedback on that as well so the information on this table provides more

[08:27:59] detailed accounting of stakeholder feedback from the 2016 math SOLs. The Department of Education staff had the pleasure of meeting with parents and public stakeholders from across the Commonwealth in Richmond, Tidewater, Northern Virginia, Blacksburg, and Stanton. And from among these, we had the opportunity to talk with a young engineer with a son who is just starting kindergarten who wanted to provide thoughts regarding the mathematics SOLs in Virginia.

[08:28:29] Northern Virginia, we also met a student, a school student who's currently in school, who gave us his thoughts and input with regards to how he believed things could be better. This provided amazing opportunity to hear diverse perspectives that helped to shape and inform the revised standards. So the input about the 2016 Math SOLs came from many different perspectives.

[08:28:56] in analyzing the comments some themes did emerge the the varying perspectives are clearly visible and ranged from input that standards should remain as they currently are written to more specific inputs such as a desire for increased rigor reduce the number of standards promote more real world applications or have a greater emphasis on data analysis in the revised standards so prior to After bringing the Draft 2023 math SOLs to the board, several groups were also provided

[08:29:33] specific opportunity to give feedback to the proposed standards in order that they may be refined and strengthened. So a dedicated group of faculty from higher ed institutions also had the opportunity to meet and provide that feedback.

[08:29:53] So a key part is down the third large bullet there is that we are seeking to receive written public feedback during the summer we are going to so there'll be written feedback there will be at least three in-person hearings if not 10 virtual hearings and then we will also be able to allow the math education advisory committee to provide feedback further superintendent coons we've also contracted with um providers above to provide outside third party analysis

[08:30:27] to respond to the fordham report and some of those things we have also um had specific um entities come out and reach out to us and we are allowing any entity that reaches out to us wants a full standards review to give us feedback on a line by line item to do that so we welcome as much feedback as possible so we're excited for these three entities but now there are others i want to make sure that we are supporting additional feedback as much as possible so i just want to say on the record from the superintendent's lens if someone says we'd like to review the standards and give line-by-line feedback we would love that input and feedback from anyone who's interested

[08:31:04] so before i hand over to miss mazekane to give you some detail about how they might look i will share that the larger picture of these standards really is that we have listened to the public we've listened to experts in the field and we have responded it is our hope to be able to provide excellent set of mathematics standards for every single student in virginia and every teacher to have as a as a baseline as a starting point to provide excellent math instruction for every child in virginia thank you thank you dr albin good afternoon my name is tina mazike i am the k-12

[08:31:42] mathematics coordinator at the virginia department of education i also come to you today as a mathematician and an educator i did teach high school mathematics for many years and have been at the department working with our wonderful math team for for quite some time i will present to you the next part of our presentation which will be an overview of the proposed changes in the draft standards of learning so an overarching focus during the process to revise the math standards is to increase the rigor and depth of the standards the national council of teachers

[08:32:16] of mathematics or nctm provides a description of rigor in mathematics rigor is defined as being able to flexibly analyze and apply mathematics to different situations with a focus on concepts and relationships. There's so much more to learning math and just memorizing a set of procedures.

[08:32:36] Rigorous math really promotes deeper understanding through making connections, both within a grade level of course and also across other disciplines and areas in a student's life. Rigor includes developing problem-solving skills, ensuring that both conceptual understanding and procedural fluency are addressed and that other processes such as communication, reasoning, and representation are included. There are four overarching areas of focus that emerged from the revision process as avenues to rigor and depth. These include improved vertical coherence through

[08:33:13] the grade levels, application and connection of concepts within a grade or course, additional data analysis to support post-secondary workforce expectations and embed the math process goals, which are problem solving, connections, communication, representation, and reasoning.

[08:33:33] So there are several broad areas in which the rigor of the content was increased in the revised standards. And there are a few examples here on the screen. One was reasoning, representing, communicating, problem solving, and making connections. Those process goals are embedded across the k-12 spectrum data analysis and the use of a data cycle in grades k-12 are also included fraction understanding in grades two through five recall and automaticity of basic facts in grades one through four geometric relationships in grades four through seven proportional reasoning and

[08:34:10] algebraic thinking in grades six through eight and translations of functions and the function progression in grades eight algebra one algebra functions and data analysis and algebra two in high school so one area of revision that we wanted to talk to you about today was and we did receive a lot of stakeholder feedback involving the recall of basic mathematics facts the acquisition of basic facts can be described as developing in three different stages developing conceptual understanding using reasoning strategies and recalling basic facts with automaticity

[08:34:47] Now these stages don't really occur in isolation, they actually are not distinct, so they all occur kind of together. And it's critical for these to happen in order for students to retain and recall basic facts, as well as develop computational fluency in general. So we wanted to show you that the draft 2023, Mathematics Standards of Learning, have some updated some expectations for students in regard to basic facts students are expected to recall with automaticity the

[08:35:22] multiplication facts through 10 times 10 and the corresponding division facts by the end of grade three this will involve standards that address the stages of developing conceptual understanding and also using reasoning strategies by the end of grade four students are expected to recall with automaticity the multiplication facts through 12 times 12 and the corresponding division facts Similar clarification has been proposed in grades K-2 regarding addition and subtraction facts.

[08:35:54] Students are expected to recall with automaticity basic addition and subtract and subtraction facts within 10 by the end of grade 1 and within 20 by the end of grade 2. Students continue to develop proficiency with and retention of basic facts as they move through the grade levels and they compute with larger whole numbers and rational numbers so students can can exhibit computational fluency as a whole when they demonstrate strategic thinking and flexibility in their computational

[08:36:29] methods and they can choose and understand and can explain the mathematics and produce accurate answers efficiently basic fact recall plays a major role in the development of overall computational fluency and it will be a large component of the revised standards so in the next several slides i'm going to show you some examples of the four areas of overarching focus that we had in our standards revision this first example on the slide shows the vertical coherence of computation of whole numbers in grades one through four and you can see the vertical progression very clearly

[08:37:05] scaffolds in complexity while continuing to build depth of knowledge around computation using addition and subtraction the development of fraction understanding in the elementary grades was an area of content that needed additional coherence and connection across the grade levels the concept of equivalency really underlies the development of that fractional progression the draft 23 standards also include proposed revisions to deepen understanding of geometric relationships such as area perimeter circumference volume and surface area by focusing on the

[08:37:44] relationships between the measurements of the components of a shape the development of this conceptual understanding and how formulas are developed as well as being able to describe and determine various measurements as scaffolded across the grades four through seven and then developing the concept of slope and its relationship to the equation of a line are proposed to scaffold from grade eight into algebra one where linear functions are then contrasted with non-linear functions including quadratic functions exponential functions and absolute

[08:38:22] value functions in algebra 2 a much more in-depth study of functions builds upon those introduced in algebra 1 along with functions such as piecewise and rational functions and as students move into mathematical analysis students are exposed to modeling contextual problems using exponential logarithmic functions the next few slides will show examples of how the draft standards provide greater support for the connection of concepts within a grade or course you know can you stop for a second sure those slides that she talked about is the importance of mathematics vertically

[08:38:57] and what we've seen is making sure that we don't skip steps when you move from fourth grade to sixth grade to eighth grade to tenth grade and i think that was a major area of emphasis i just want to compliment the team and some of the feedback we've received nationally in the review of the standards is we have done a much better job of making sure those vertical progressions are much clearer and much more concrete so there's no vagueness and as you move up above into those vertical coherence so i'm just going to use some non-academic mathy language for the board just to say we we worked really hard to make sure that as students progress between grades that that clear

[08:39:34] standard level is very clear for teachers so they know exactly what they're responsible in their grade level and they're not like well are they covering this next year are they covering it last year it's very clear by grade level and has much more clarity and is something that our outside support is also looking at to make sure that we have no gaps in that vertical coherence and now Tina is going to talk about that those coherence inside the grade band and making sure that it's super clear inside that grade band as well yeah thank you superintendent Coons that it's very important we have spent a lot of time looking at the vertical coherence and the connections within

[08:40:08] the greater course are also extremely important in grade three and grade two we actually moved the the concept of congruence into grade two so it would connect better to the concept of symmetry and when it comes to geometric figures another example is grade seven where students look at proportional reasoning which is a huge big idea in middle school across three different strands you can see how this big idea extends through computation and estimation. It extends through measurement and geometry, and also patterns, functions, and algebra. The dilation of geometric

[08:40:46] figures was actually moved from grade eight to grade seven, so that that would more support that idea of proportional reasoning for students. Another shift, and this is the third shift we want to talk about, is being proposed that deepens student analysis of data using a data cycle.

[08:41:06] the cycle shown on the slide includes steps similar to the scientific method or the engineering design process and it's proposed in the standards for grades k all the way through algebra 2. the standards across all the grades will build components of the data cycle each greater course scaffolds the data analysis by focusing on specific visualizations of data that increase in complexity and require analysis and interpretation superintendent and superintendent coons talked about the fordom report and that was a report from

[08:41:41] august of 2018 and it kind of connects um to this this area that we're going to talk about with math process goals the report was titled state of state standards post common core and in the report the standards of each state both in math and english language arts were reviewed the k-12 revision teams that worked on these draft standards actually took a look at this report and were asked to analyze it and to look at the findings to try and make sure that we're incorporating some of those recommended changes one of the fundamental weaknesses that was in the report was the lack

[08:42:15] of emphasis on developing conceptual understanding in the standards and one way that's been addressed in the draft standards is through the embedding of the five mathematical process goals so clarifications and additions have been made to the proposed standards such as those you can see on this item in the elementary grades they extend up go back to that one i want to talk about this from a parent perspective and something that's very important that we're working on from an assessment standpoint when we talk about explain justify communicate solve those are very clear

[08:42:54] measurable verbs that are incorporated in the standard that actually say how deep we need to go and it's very important as we get better at writing standards and i'm really proud that the math standards actually have these very tight verbs in them that makes it clear to a family member exactly what my child's supposed to do with the base 10 system right how what am i supposed to be able to do i have to justify solutions that doesn't mean i write five on the paper and move on i have to explain that so it's it's this is a strong opportunity for us to get more clear on exactly what the standards mean not just for our teachers but for the people who are writing

[08:43:33] assessment items for our families to understand exactly what the standards are asking of students and the level of understanding they have to be able to communicate and explain and be able to demonstrate so i'm really excited that we have some of these tight verbs in all of our standards across the board because it really helps the communication pieces and the clarity and expectations i could ask a question now or should i wait till the end of the basket now bill um just along those lines i'm just maybe again i'm gonna drive everybody here nuts going back to the nape and the sol scores again but i just um when i look at the that we had the worst in the country

[08:44:13] change from 2017 to 2022 in the math fourth grade nape scores and our sol scores are also 15 20 points down from two years ago and again and i'm looking forward to learning more about the the conceptual framing in this, but I'm a little concerned with the conceptual framing if that's also going to be taken away from the core hard things that you're talking about here and if there's more time spent on that.

[08:44:45] And so some of the hard learning is going to get lost and there's going to be more compression in grades six, seven, eight when the higher, more tougher things are going to be taught to them. So I just, A, would maybe just like to understand a little bit from all of your outside group advisory focal points for the last year and a half.

[08:45:12] I just, I still sometimes feel like we've got to just focus on blocking and tackling and the basics. And I feel like I'm sounding like a broken record every month here, but I just want to make sure on the conceptual stuff that's not getting us off track to get us not just back to where we were, but being better than we were since we were the worst in the country for the last five years.

[08:45:35] I think that balance between the conceptual and the process goals actually gets us at that. Because if we just say, think about this math concept and develop an understanding, those are very fluffy, vague conceptual spaces. But if I have to justify what I'm doing, that's actually explaining the hard math and telling you exactly how I got there.

[08:45:56] So when we want children to do more of the constructed deep end responses that are on NAEP, they have to justify their answers, and when we say that in the verb on the standard, that actually is clear to that teacher that I have to get all the way there. and it's not I have to develop an understanding, which means a lot of different things to a lot of different educators. If it says I have to justify my answer, and that's what some of the questions on NAEP on the constructive response asked for, it actually clarifies that depth that they have to get to so that you're not then backtracking in eighth grade, oh, it's not fluffy

[08:46:31] anymore. It's actually hard math. It actually becomes much more clear in that vertical coherence. And that is why those three outside providers that they had on that slide, those specific comparison pieces to the Fordham and national expectations, that is what they're doing to make sure that we don't continue to regress, but that we are being so clear and so rigorous in that balance that we're making sure we're asking students to demonstrate both that basic piece, but also the depth of conceptual understanding at that level in a clear way that allows us to get to really hard math as we move.

[08:47:08] but mr president yes ma'am if i may just mr hanson i just want to seek a little clarification you're referring to the nape scores virginia being the worst in the nation and i share concern your very well-grounded concern about the significant drop in the virginia nape scores which i think were the worst or close to the worst in the nation on some of the measures but am i correct you're referring to the virginia being uh the differential for virginia in the drop but virginia's just to

[08:47:43] clarify virginia's math nape scores are about average not the bottom by any means am i right about that you are but we were way above average before we had the largest drop i got it just you want to make sure i understand we were well above average and now we're average which is not where we want to be still above average still above average but not as much above average because we had the largest we had the largest drop in the country thank you i just heard that referred to that stat a number of times and i just wanted to clarify thank you thank you mr hanson your your question is is is well taken and and the balance that that

[08:48:20] superintendent coons talks about is is very much important and i think you'll be able to see that as we look through the standards and and and it comes out very clearly this example in middle school really is focusing on the process of representation um so when we we start to build conceptual understanding for example about integers we want want students to be using models and benchmarks to be able to to understand equivalency among decimals and fractions and percents so it's the representation and the benchmarks that allow the students to build that conceptual understanding when they're comparing and ordering numbers for example in grade seven

[08:48:58] and real numbers in grade eight you'll also see that as we look at the high school standards that those process goals are embedded across those standards as well so we did provide you with a set of draft standards and a set of draft summary documents so we wanted to take a little bit of time just to outline what the what the structure is of those two documents so you understand um how they're put together um so the uh the attachment to in the board item which is posted for june 15th has the draft 23 mathematics standards of learning and in that draft is also

[08:49:36] included some front matter information that incorporates some introductory statements each grade level or course has an introduction and then the standards of learning are there and they're grouped by a content strand in each of the grades or courses in the other document which is found in attachment one in that same board item for june 15th we have what we're calling summary documents and dr albin had had referred to these earlier that they really show an overview of the revisions so i wanted to just show you some examples of each of those

[08:50:12] and before i do that i want to compare how this you know let's be respectful that it's 20 till 6 and i love our board members but they're starting to eat dinner out of bags so let's show them no no no no i want to make sure you're eating but let's show them one and then ask questions and if they're good let's keep moving to make sure that we're disrespectful that they have been here a very long time today absolutely yeah so this is a grade seven example this is the standards of learning document where you see that there's the strand and the standards are shown below that when you look at the summary documents there's kind of three different parts to that the first

[08:50:47] part is a revision or overview of all the content so you can kind of get a one-stop look at that as you go into the rest of the summary documents there's a side-by-side comparison we feel this is very useful to you all to see what was that standard in 2016 and now what is it in 2023 and how can i discern the differences so that part of those documents will be very helpful to you the other part of the document includes a four quadrant table and the first quadrant shows the numbers as they change from 2016 to 2023 there's another part that talks about how the

[08:51:24] parameters of the standards were changed um and some clarifications that were built into that that greater force and then deletions and addition so what was added to this set of standards what was

deleted and there's a key at the bottom to help you kind of see some of the coding that we've put together to help to help to talk through those standards there's a list of some references that our team and has looked at along with the other experts so you have that list to take a look at we also wanted to talk just a little bit about what this means for mathematics assessment i think you're all very familiar with the assessments that occur in virginia

[08:52:01] at a state level and this slide kind of shows that but we also want to make sure that the draft standards you're aware that provide they provide more clarity and they provide well-defined expectations for students educators and parents they also provide and are paired with that clarity and depth so we can look at clear language expectations for teachers and for those that write our assessments along with strengthening that ability to provide gifted post-mastery learning opportunities so next steps in this process is we and with your approval after we

[08:52:38] have this first review tomorrow we'll be we'll be going out on public hearings and getting collecting feedback both in written and then through those hearing opportunities um hopefully in august and september we will come to you with a final review um and then in um in terms of implementation this is is a change from what was brought to the board in january of 2022 the crosswalk year which is when the teachers teach both the 2016 and the 2023 standards is now going to be 2023-24 and tina just to clarify that crosswalk here is a local determination on

[08:53:12] how that works or how they make that happen right that locals decide on that crosswalk component and how they do that correct correct and sometimes we actually have school divisions that will implement the earlier grades right away and they don't necessarily have a crosswalk here and then full implementation would be in 2024 2025 so we do anticipate that teachers will need support in the implementation of the standards so we will be emphasizing uh through professional learning um some of the ideas about the increase in rigor and depth and in the areas that we've

[08:53:48] talked about today those four areas of focus we will hopefully be using different modalities to help teachers learn about the changes to the standards and we will also be working with groups of teachers to revise instructional resources because we know that with the new standards comes new alignment and we'll be working on that as well i will say i've had the opportunity to speak with seven regional groups of superintendents tomorrow i will get to speak with our last region which is region one one of the things they have asked for in the math support as we've talked

[08:54:22] about the math changes at each one of our superintendent meetings they have asked for regional networks and regional supports and we talked with the math team that we think will be able to do that you talked about the difference between what rural school divisions and some of our regions might need region 8 was very clear yesterday about some of the things they would like to see i think that we have talked about that and are excited to be responsive to our superintendents and really tailoring some of that professional development that tina showed on the slide to what our superintendents have discussed over the past couple weeks as we've talked with

[08:54:58] them about the changes in the math standards thank you and thank you we're happy to answer questions that you may have just thank you this is amazing work and i really appreciate all the effort that's gone into it just quick question on the cadence of the curriculum framework and how that's going to be handled um you want me to do that sure so one of the things that we have heard from the assessment task force from the superintendents from the assessment feedback is it's really hard to have

[08:55:31] a curriculum framework and a set of standards and trying to figure out which document matters so part of what this team has done which is phenomenal is they've taken the no's and do's out of the curriculum framework and actually embedded those in the standards so you're getting a comprehensive standards document that allows all of that to be embedded together and then these dynamic instructional guides which they will partner with expert teachers across the state and really build out model lessons model resources model things like that so this is the first time we will shift

[08:56:07] away from old school kind of generalized standards and then curriculum frameworks those knows and do's inside those curriculum frameworks are actually embedded in the standards document just along those lines to just when you're going out to the teachers and i know math is a different issue for a lot of parents including myself um but just in terms of the materials that are going to be user-friendly um before the public meetings just any thoughts on how that's going to be handled we know that um reaching parents is very important so we'll be working with teacher

[08:56:47] groups to hopefully develop more of those sorts of resources so that they feel included in the process and can understand the changes we we feel like the state level we can help guide that we've actually talked with many of the leaders across the state that they feel that's a priority as well that they'd like to work on with us and our superintendents actually in the past two weeks jeremy and i've got a lot of feedback they have asked us to put packages together that are clear and friendly that we can give to all superintendents across the state that have a parent function a community function and so when we um fully build out that comms team we're excited to have those

[08:57:25] packages just like you said so that we can give them to small rurals we can have large larger school divisions customize those but that's one thing that they've asked us for more of these packaged resources that they can turn and take and be very clear so we're really i think our superintendents were very excited about that but we're also excited um first of all i one of the slides i saw that you were looking at that the nape is like it's back so that i think it's usually important because for example you know our fourth grade scores one impact is organizational we we teach things in fifth grade that nape tests in fourth grade so that that's going to be pretty

[08:58:04] pretty helpful to look at from that perspective too i'm really excited about you know this types of standards leading to a radical innovation in the way we assess mathematics in the future and so i'm excited about the potential there but i think for the board's point of view for feedback that we're receiving expecting tomorrow let's pop back to the crosswalk piece for just a moment so what i think i heard you say is that um that 23-24 come upcoming school year is the crosswalk year but the extent to which a division goes down that path is local control understanding that by

[08:58:41] 24-25 they've got to be playing the new standards um i'm sorry can you answer that out loud for the audience sure sure the 2023-24 school year would be a crosswalk year and we do intend to provide some support so that the teachers can see if something moved from one grade to the other that they'll have that support to help them be ready for 24-25 and the definition of a crosswalk year

[08:59:09] is defined at the local level uh well so first i just want to applaud this amazing work you all obviously have done an incredible job gathering input and putting it together in a way that makes sense even somewhat to us lay people but obviously uh to the stakeholders and the great news is that looking at the public comment that we've received just in the first four or five days and obviously

[08:59:44] it's only been that since these were posted but um seems like there are folks who want to raise an issue here or an issue there but uh overall seems very positive on the content of what you've done so congratulations on that and i hope i look forward to a very smooth acceptance of these standards on first review tomorrow and then that we'll have the opportunity to hear from the public more extensively and from other reviewers and hopefully come up with a really best-in-class standard great to hear from alan that we're aligning the content with what nape expects us

[09:00:20] to do at what grade levels that's a huge a huge uh step in the right direction my uh my concern is on this crosswalk question um that obviously a lot of divisions are not understanding it the way i think i'm hearing it from you we've got comment in the public comment again just since the four or five days since this was posted from a lot of from 30 some divisions i'm counting administrators in 30 some divisions including all of our largest divisions so representing the overwhelming majority of students in the commonwealth saying that what they what it looks

[09:00:59] like you're asking them to do is to be prepared to incorporate this com content in some fashion in the 23-24 school year and they're telling us that's not possible and it makes sense to me that it's not possible because i don't want us to rush this content i want us to hear from the public i want us to hear you want you all to have a chance to respond to what you hear from the public and what you hear from other reviewing entities and then come back to us with an even better draft and i can't imagine that happening before september maybe more realistically october um and even if

[09:01:33] we magically somehow managed to do that in august there are school divisions have already done all their training and their preparing and their curriculum implementation for 2324. So that's what I hear in the public comment. I hear all these divisions saying we can't possibly incorporate this content in any meaningful way in 2324. If a school division chooses not to, can they choose to teach 2324 completely based on the 2016 math standards and then get themselves ready to switch

[09:02:12] completely to the new standards in time for the 24-25 school year that that certainly would be possible we're happy um as a as a department to support um the changes that that they might need to be aware of so to ensure that students aren't at any detriment by missing content that may have moved that's that would really be our only concern at the department is that if there was something that shifted from one grade to another that we'd want teachers to be aware of that so we're happy to provide support and work with teams of teachers just to make sure that there might be a couple things that they might need to fold in that will make sure that there's a smooth transition into

[09:02:49] 24-25 so that helps me understand why we i mean it seems to me like our normal process what apparently appears to be our normal process of having very slow turnover to the new standards i mean essentially what i'm hearing from the divisions normally we would have a full year of cross world walk and in other words that these standards wouldn't really be implemented for two full years from now and that seems awfully slow and i don't understand why we would need to take that long so on and on the other hand i understand why the divisions feel like it will be very hard to prepare their teachers to teach on these new standards starting at the beginning of the 23

[09:03:27] school year because these standards aren't even going to be done by then and their preparation certainly will be done their summer academies etc will all be long over and yet i i what i'm hearing you say is one of the questions it's not just a matter of preparing the teachers in time to teach in 24 25 but that students being tested in 24 25 might have missed something because of the shift from one year to the next

so that might mean that in 24 25 if they don't do any crosswalk work in in 23, 24, then they might have to add some content in 24, 25 for some students in some grades.

[09:04:06] Is that what I'm understanding? - That's correct. That they would just need to make sure that they've absorbed that shift either in the crosswalk year or in the full implementation. - And you're prepared to help support the divisions on that. And is it a manageable amount such that, you know, if I division XYZ teach completely the 23, 24 standards, I mean, excuse me, complete teach only the 2016 standards 23-24 is it going to be manageable for me to help the students catch up the missing content in 24-25 we we hope to put together um documents that will help support that so that it is a

[09:04:42] manageable piece of of information that teachers could manage and that leaders could help them you know but the amount of learning that would be required for students would in the 24-25 school year would be managed at the amount of extra content from what we've looked at that the changes should allow that management to occur and with each grade level is a little bit different so that's why we really feel like we need to sit with some some teachers and put together things that will really be supportive of their instruction well it would be my hope that obviously this this expedited implementation which i fully support in concept that you all will be able to work with the

[09:05:22] divisions and i don't think that's something we have to vote on or make any decisions about tomorrow i think partly you all just need to communicate to the divisions their what their opportunities are but we can accept it on first review but the more you can clarify this with the divisions the more our public hearings will be about the content rather than about the implementation schedule that's correct yes and i'll take that piece of feedback and make sure that we assure that we do that well thank you can i ask one question although you know i hate to do this at close to six o'clock and you know I won't be here to vote on the finals anyway but you know we always

[09:05:58] talk about doing best in class uh and I certainly appreciate the concept of you know refining the vertical and making sure everything builds upon it and I'm sure that in 2000 whatever it was the people came before us and said we're building a better mousetrap than we had the past how do we know and i guess you know i appreciate mr hansen's comments but how do we know that what we're doing is actually better preparing our kids for what they're going to face in life which you know the ultimate goal i mean we love the test scores and that's great and it's a measure of something not

[09:06:34] clear to me yet even after seven years of doing this how much those test scores relate to later life but you know in terms of what our graduates need to know if you take this at the end and bring it on back we test pieces of this in the field i mean how do we know it increases rigor how do we know it increases achievement uh or are we just doing a new set of standards that we think is are going to do those things um president gecker what our kids need to know mathematics today is very different than seven years ago and i think one of the pieces that is outstanding in our feedback

[09:07:14] is getting that higher education that post-secondary workforce that feedback loop and one of the things i'm really proud of is the level of data science that they've incorporated because one of the things we've heard back from the field is that our kiddos need better data science they need to know probability they need to know statistics those are real world things that they need to better understand and know and actually as they go to college-based mathematics they have more statistics than they do in some other things so the team is doing that well and one of the things i've asked peter co specifically to do

in the high school mathematics is to do some of that analysis across so that's definitely something post-secondary workforce is near and near to my heart making

[09:07:53] sure our kids are prepared for those high demand high wage jobs and i think that's extremely important in mathematics given where we are with math so we want to make sure that those high school standards continue to evolve for that that's one of the things we're testing for so i appreciate the question thank you all right thank you guys very much we appreciate it i guess we'll see you tomorrow thank you is that right all of you coming back tomorrow yes sir great we look forward to all right i know there's going to be some pushback on this but you know i'm dying to hear dr holland's three minutes of sped so three minutes is what i'm told thank you so much welcome

[09:08:30] thank you so much for having me and i've never gotten to say this before but good evening president gecker board members and dr coons um as you all well know i'm dr samantha marsh hollands the assistant superintendent for special education and student support services here at vdoe and today it's my pleasure and i'm charged with giving you an update on both state and federal reports regarding special education both the visit and report from the u.s department of education's office of special education programs as well as the state study that was conducted by the joint legislative audit and review commission or jlark the jlark study came as a result of action within

[09:09:06] the 2018 general assembly session and consisted of an extensive review that was primarily focused on the state education agency with a final report that was released in december of 2020. the board approved final action on updated guidance around graduation in december of 2022 which brought to a close the department's implementation of each of the 27 recommendations from the jlark report regardless if they were required by general assembly action or not so the department took the stance that they were proactive improvement areas and really committed to fulfilling the requirements

[09:09:40] that the study has undertaken the time to identify for us as i shift to kind of looking at what came next both of these activities had a significant amount of overlap in april of 2019 the virginia department of education received a letter from the office of special education programs notifying us that they would be on site the very next month which was may of 2019 to conduct what they called a differentiated monitoring and supervision review or dms it's really who is in charge of monitoring special education at this each of the state education agencies so this federal agency is

[09:10:15] in charge of doing that for each state and territory throughout the country that initial visit occurred in may and we received those findings and a report that was shared with us in june of 2020 and those implemented actions and guidance responsive to those findings began in september of 2020 and obviously that's been an ongoing process in partnership with our federal partners there were quite a few pieces of high level actions that were required as a result of that corrective action those are captured here and they speak to really the focus of the review which was on state policies practices and procedures so as opposed to focusing and finding

[09:10:54] issue with local implementation of services what they really concentrated on and dug into was how the state administers the programs and so as a result of that the corrective actions were really around procedures that are required by the individuals with disabilities education act and you know they were very clear and that's what they were able to find in their review as a result of this work we continue to partner with the u.s department of education to implement information and guidance and actions to this

report but we also anticipate a follow-up visit from that office later on this year and we look forward to strengthening our efforts around continuous improvement which is really what we're committed to

[09:11:33] obviously with also focusing on bringing some of these actions to a close that's something that we really worked with our federal partners to help them articulate what remains for the state department to execute so that we can move on to other areas of sight as has been the case in the past and what we anticipate in the future there may be items that require board action and so i wanted to provide a little bit of an update of which many of you may be remembering that you acted on in november of 2021 and updating some of the regulatory language as a result of that communication from the federal government. The department has really used these reports and

[09:12:09] their findings to make much needed updates and improvements to our state system for general supervision and monitoring and so it's something we can definitely work to keep the board informed about but much more importantly concentrate on the areas where you might need your partnership and action to ensure that Virginia remains in high compliance with what's required through the Individuals with Disabilities Education Act. You know on a final note too I do also want to address that there's obviously a lot of communication that the board has both received on these reports and on special education generally we know how committed we are to working in this

[09:12:44] area and particularly the um the concerns and i think the the impact this work has on our most vulnerable populations and i do want to convey my appreciation to dr king specifically for her leadership and support and really helping us to to reinvigorate and ensure the commitment that department staff have to work with families to to navigate the complexity of the special education process that we know can face them so with that um i'll pause and i'll be happy to answer any clarification questions and dr coons has some comments i asked sam to give you guys a quick update today knowing that there's lots of things you want to talk about so she has just run through

[09:13:24] a quick update one of the things um secretary gadarin i went to visit osep last month and ask them for really clear guidance and feedback of what they love to see in Virginia moving forward and so Sam and I are sitting together Sam's office has moved under my office right now in our transition and one of the things we're working on is looking at how the staff is structured how we're responding to families how are we monitoring how are we doing some of the things that we're doing and how are we prioritizing those we will be adding an office of parent engagement there is several positions available on the website that we are very excited to fill

[09:14:01] to lever a whole office of parent support and think about some positions that directly support our families navigating some of the difficult things that happen in special education but what we love to hear from you is what do you want to hear in a deep dive approach around special education in july sam just gave you a very fast drive-by at the end of a very long day on some special education updates and i know that you're tired but we really want to ask you as we move forward into july what are some things you want us to bring are there experts you want us to bring

[09:14:36] are is there sets of data are there resources updates on a deep dive approach that we could provide for you in july sam and i would be excited to do that but we want to know directionality from the board what you would like us to do a deep dive on i maybe start just thank you this is great and also superintendent i appreciate the office that you're setting up and the focal point i think those are all going

to be very helpful instruments to get us where we need to go i i think for july one thing that all of this is so important with our compliance with the department of education

[09:15:15] spent 15 years of my life there i understand that but to me i feel like as a board really just pulling back the the levers of i just feel like our system is fundamentally broken it's not an indictment on anybody here it's just institutionally an incredibly complex um um that i think just so many times loses the focal point of the free and appropriate education that the intent of the law was really to provide and i would really like to just figure out if there's a way that we can

[09:15:54] come up with a better design a better framework a better system um i i just i've lived this personally of family members daughter that's a special ed teacher and administrator and the system is just horrible in every which way that is anti-family pro-lawyer pro-litigation it's pro system and so to me it's all of this stuff is very important because we we don't have all of this

[09:16:27] coming along seamlessly for uh for our compliance and accountability purposes but to me it is just really the infrastructure out there and the whole culture that has you know been created over the last 40 50 years of the implementation of the 1974 act and how and to me that's really where i would like to focus is how do we just fundamentally look at a system that is more student focused more parent focused less um bureaucracy focused less uh protecting the system

[09:17:06] and um so that's kind of a high bar and a lot to say but to me that's really what we've got to kind of get back to is what is going to be helping our you know most of any students and families that are dealing with this challenge every day of their lives so just speaking for myself for um uh building on mr hansen's comments i agree with uh if we get some stuff on uh demographics especially in virginia i'm particularly interested in sort of non-specific learning disabilities because i

[09:17:44] think it's a lot of our hope that we're going to see that number go down when we start to improve reading instruction with the direction we're going but to help us understand that a timeline would be fantastic about sort of where we are on monitoring we're hearing different things from why we're even in monitoring and some people are saying well it's just a routine thing and other people say no there are targeted deficiencies have been identified and that's why um osep is monitoring us helping the board understand like what is actually going on what are our responses to those kind of where are we in that would i think be um extremely valuable and then this

[09:18:20] issue that keeps coming up, help us get our head around what's this issue with hearing officers, it keeps coming up and is, I completely agree, the way the law is set up, it is set up to be adversarial, it is set up to, and there's some of that stuff, that's federal law and federal civil rights law, and we're not going to change it, but within that framework we have to operate and what can we do and what do we need to be doing there to make sure that parents' rights are being fully respected the process is working and balancing everything and so that those are those are uh three areas that uh one that i'm just very interested in the reading issue and then the other

[09:18:56] two uh that seem to keep coming up from stakeholders and i agree i think smith the data on adhd or autism or just just the changes in the population in the last 10 years and just the soft issues you know with reading and learning challenged individuals and just again the identification and all the issues that go around it but it'd just be helpful to kind of just understand how the landscape has been shifting because that's shifting what we need to do to try to not just address it today but to address it for the future as well and obviously a demographic overlay on all

[09:19:34] that because there's been problems in the past with over-representation and so forth and i i don't know where we are on that it's very helpful to learn you know where we make progress and where there's challenges so janet you asked about you know ideas for july this is going to be profoundly important work that's going to take time and it's going to take a lot of people working together at all levels in this regard i would suggest that language is important i think that you know for july when the board changes yet again we a presentation with a little one pager of glossary

[09:20:11] um you know so we can have we can be talking about the same things so we can have a refresher on what is fake and so we can talk about least restrictive environment and you know just we so we're talking about the right things and we're all using when we're saying things we're using the right terms i think that's going to help us moving forward that we're real consistent in our language so that's kind of a foundational thing a macro level thing i hope we can avoid some false dichotomies one of them sometimes is well um procedure procedure procedure versus out student outcome student outcomes and and you know i think we should avoid that false dichotomy and that you

[09:20:49] know solid procedures will be connected to positive student outcomes and we we want to certainly we need to be compliant but being able to check every box uh versus you know monitoring the success of every child uh it'll be very complex work but i think we need to start with some special ed 101 in july so thank you for the opportunity for even even with our fried brains to weigh in on and i'll just endorse everything i've heard uh two things uh i don't want us to get unduly

[09:21:24] focused on the compliance pieces i agree we want to be more substantive but within the compliance world anything that specifically potentially calls for board action so if i understand it there may be some regulatory issues that osep has raised with us that may require board action to address i'd love to be updated on what those issues are and what the proposed timeline is to help us address it and then my more substantive thing it might well i'll state my hypothesis is one of i

[09:21:57] suspect one of the contributing causes to frustration among parents with outcomes and classroom experiences of their children with special education is our special ed workforce issues that we have an extremely high high number of vacancies and of inexperienced and under prepared teachers we have more provisionally licensed teachers in special ed by a wide margin and in other fields and it just i i have seen evidence of teachers who are in a position

[09:22:36] where they're we have essentially no training at all dealing with some of our children with their toughest needs and it's no surprise at all to me that the parents and everybody are frustrated including the teacher and that the teacher then quits in the middle of the year and then you know it just compounds so my and obviously that's a very big picture not all of which you or we can fix but within that i'd love to hear the department's assessment of this the extent of issues with the special ed workforce and the extent of the department's

[09:23:15] and or the board's opportunity to impact that and even if it's we're impacting it simply by putting something in our annual report to the general assembly because it may well come down to money or to other issues but are there things we can do in licensure are there things we can do in professional development are there things we can do by way of making recommendations to the general assembly or including in our annual report that can help address the the workforce issues to the extent that if if if you have any sense about whether are they if they are a contributing factor

[09:23:48] 14 items okay ready um maybe 15. yeah well i got a list so um i i think i am especially excited for and encouraged by the parent engagement special ed ombuds that we have sitting out there hopefully coming soon um but i do think that kind of piggybacking on what alan was saying i do think perhaps it might be a good opportunity not only for us to do the acronym soup discussion to give

[09:24:26] to our friends that are coming on to the board but also talk about sort of I think a lot of this oftentimes comes from a lack of consistency in our identification processes across different locality so you know in one locality a family might take their child for identification and get a massive iep that serves them exactly the way they want and then they go to another school division with the same set of of issues perhaps and and have nothing get nothing and so i think

[09:25:04] there is a real consistency issue that i think is also part of that root of the problem um and And then also identification terminology, there is so much identification that is used in different school divisions all over the place.

[09:25:24] So, you know, you might have school divisions providing pretty specific identification, whereas another school division might just lump some kids into an OHI. And that's not exactly giving us the data that we need, so maybe thinking more about that.

[09:25:42] of we don't use ed anymore in some school divisions where others use oh hi so just my thoughts anybody else i would just like to add i appreciate that's very valuable feedback for dr coons and i the one thing i would request is some grace from the board on the timeline um i also note that because very importantly your advisory committee on special education is planned to come to you in september which i think can really help to initially provide some additional viewpoints on some of these and so i would just make that request um as we part this evening but thank you so much for your feedback i really appreciate it thank you dr hollens i appreciated that three

[09:26:22] minutes greatly all right i think that's all the business that's coming before the board today uh we are adjourned we'll see you all tomorrow at nine

